

Bazooka - Rocket Launcher M1A1

PAGES FROM THE ORIGINAL MANUAL

Weapons (Marine Infantry Battalion), Marine Corps Schools,
Quantico (1943)

WHAT'S INSIDE

The 2.36-inch rocket launcher M1A1: description, labelled
photographs, the sights, loading and firing positions.

11 pages from the original follow: the manual's cover, then the section about this
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RESTRICTED

A SUPPLEMENT TO
WEAPONS
(Marine Infantry Battalion)

(NAVMC—3551)

H. F. ECKER.



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MARINE CORPS SCHOOLS
MARINE BARRACKS, QUANTICO, VIRGINIA

SECTION 17

2.36-INCH AT ROCKET LAUNCHER M1A1

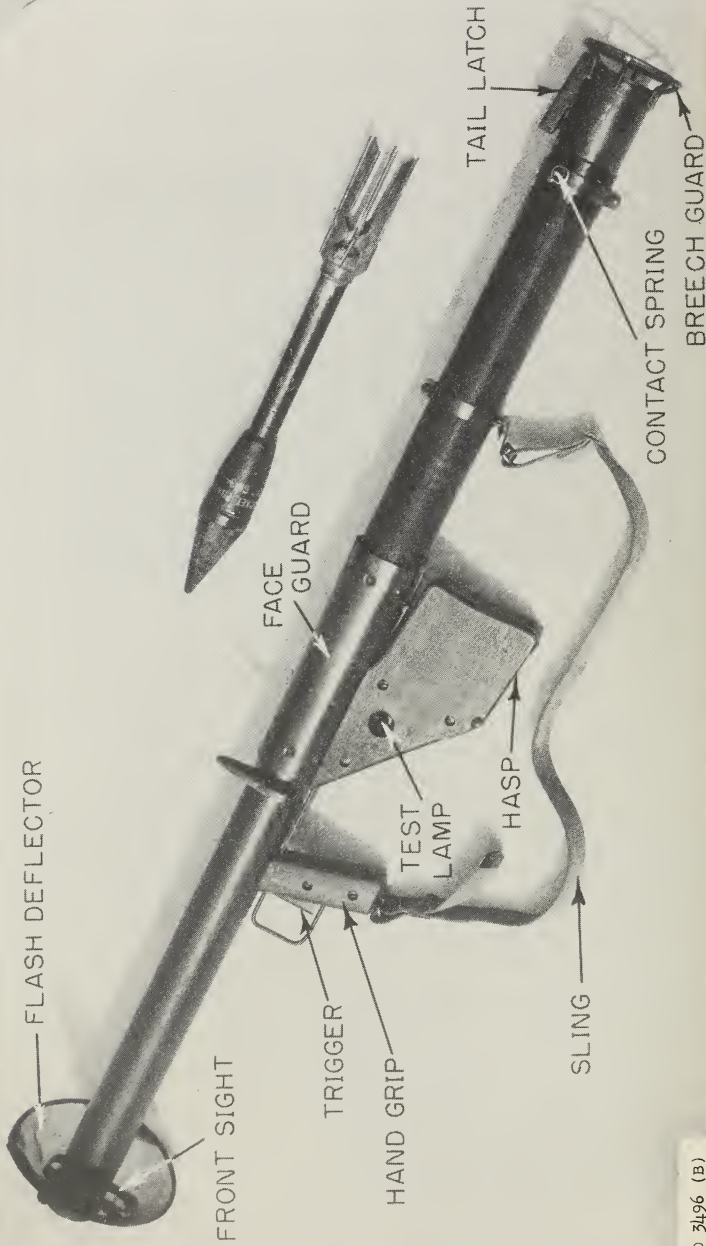
1. **General.**—The rocket launcher, or “Bazooka,” as it is better known, forms the principal element of defense in the rifle company against tanks and armored vehicles, and has proven to be highly effective for the close-in assault of fortified positions such as pill boxes and emplacements made of concrete and steel or other permanent material.

2. **Essential Characteristics.**—a. **Description.**—The 2.36-inch AT Rocket Launcher M1A1 is a smooth bore, electrically operated weapon of the open tube type, with a stock which houses the electrical firing mechanism. It is fired from the shoulder in the standing, kneeling, sitting, or prone positions. When fired, gases formed by the ignition of the propelling charge are able to escape through the rear of the tube while most of the force pushes forward to drive the rocket out the muzzle of the tube; this feature eliminates recoil.

An earlier model, the M1, had two hand grips; the M1A1 has but one, consisting of trigger grips attached to the trigger support. The M1A1 also has a conical wire screen mounted on the front, known as a flash deflector, a carrying sling, and a face guard, features not found on the M1 launcher.

b. **General data.**—

Weight of launcher (approx.)	_____ (pounds)	13.26
Length of launcher (approx.)	_____ (inches)	54.5
Internal diameter of launcher	_____ (inches)	2.37
Weight of rocket (approx.)	_____ (pounds)	3.5
Length of rocket (approx.)	_____ (inches)	21.6
Muzzle velocity	_____ (feet per second)	265
Maximum effective range	_____ (yards)	300
Maximum range	_____ (yards)	700
Sights graduated to	_____ (yards)	300



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Figure 57.—2.36-inch AT Rocket Launcher M1A1—Left Side View.

2.36-Inch AT Rocket Launcher M1A1

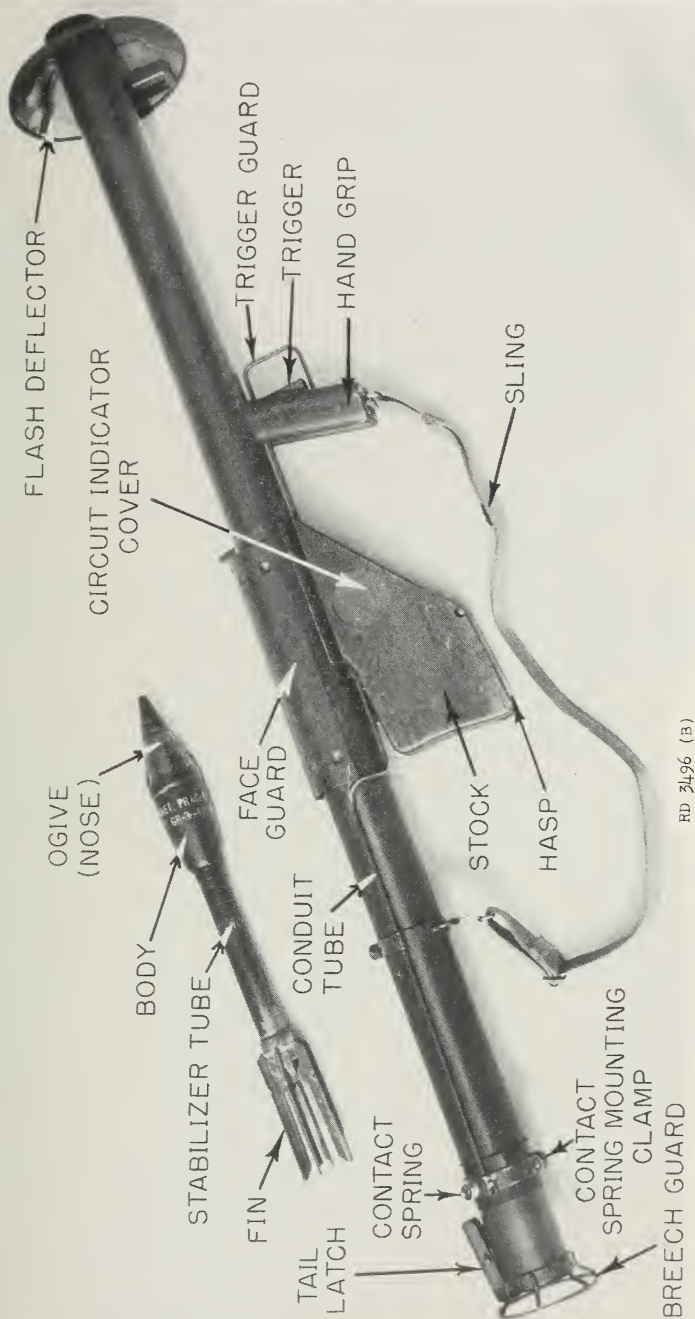


Figure 58.—2.36-inch AT Rocket Launcher M1A1—Right Side View.

c. **Sights.**—The M1A1 launcher has a front and rear sight, both of which are fixed to the barrel on the left side. The rear sight is of the peep type. The front sight consists of three studs which are used for ranges of 100, 200, and 300 yards. Intermediate or greater ranges, lead, and windage must be estimated by the firer.

Some of the earlier models of the AT Rocket Launcher, M1, had a double front sight with studs for ranges of 100, 200, 300, and 400 yards, and a hinged rear sight of the slot type so that the launcher could be fired from either the right or left shoulder.

3. **Ammunition Supply.**—a. The ammunition currently authorized for use in the M1A1 rocket launcher is as follows:*

Rocket, HE, AT, 2.36-inch, M6A3; Rocket, HE, AT, 2.36-inch, M6A1.

Rocket, practice, 2.36-inch, M7A3; Rocket, practice, 2.36-inch, M7A1.

* NOTE: HE—High Explosive; AT—Antitank; M—model number; A—modification number.

b. The ammunition issued for the M1 launcher was known as the M6 and M7 Rockets. These cannot be used in the M1A1 launcher.

c. The unit of fire is five rockets per launcher.

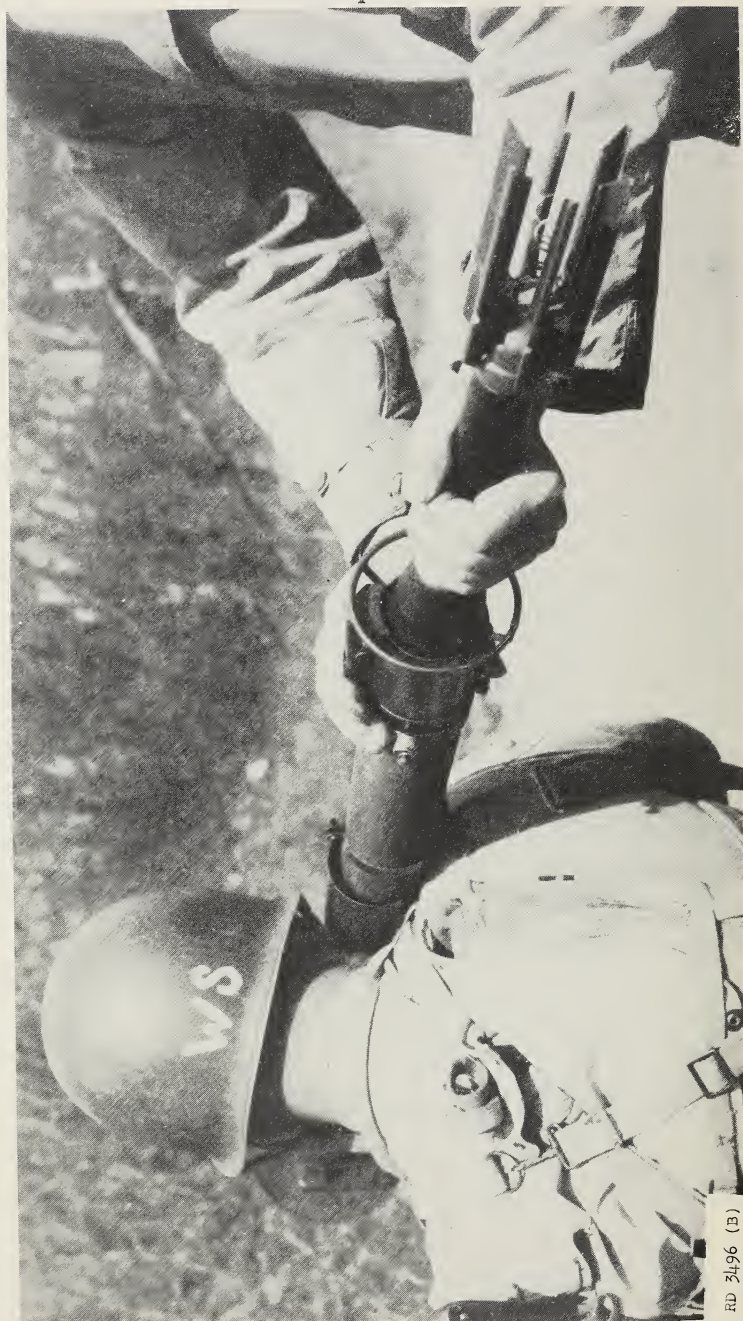
d. Rockets may also be buried in the ground as anti-tank mines.

4. **Employment.**—The rocket launcher is used in combat to launch high-explosive rockets against tanks, armored vehicles, pill boxes, and emplacements. It is operated by a two-man team, one to fire and one to load the weapon. In order to achieve greater accuracy and assist in effecting surprise, fire against moving targets should be withheld until the last practicable moment. Where terrain favors a hostile tank attack, the launchers should be near that part of the company most threatened by such an attack. During reorganization after an attack, and in the defense, they should be placed near the perimeter of the company to cover the most likely avenues of mechanized approach. The company commander will coordinate the use of the rocket launchers with any other antitank protection furnished his company.

5. **Precautions.**—Three major precautions must be observed in using this weapon and its ammunition:

a. No personnel or inflammable material should ever be directly behind the loaded launcher within a distance of 20 feet. When the rocket is fired, there is considerable back blast which can cause serious burns. When firing from trenches or fox-holes, clearance should be provided so that the back blast is not deflected against personnel.

b. If no flash deflector is available, the firer should have his hands and face protected against possible backflash as the rocket leaves the muzzle of the launcher, especially in cold weather when combustion of the propelling charge may be retarded. Both the loader and firer should wear steel helmets when using the launcher.



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Figure 59.—Loading the Rocket Launcher.

2.36-Inch AT Rocket Launcher M1A1

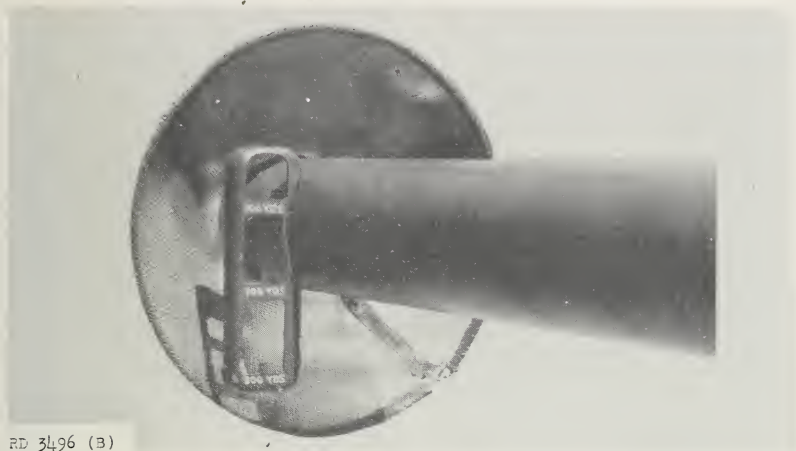


Figure 60.—Front Sight and Flash Deflector of Rocket Launcher.

Weapons



Figure 62.—High Kneeling Position.



Figure 61.—Standing Position.

2.36-Inch AT Rocket Launcher M1A1



Figure 63.—Low Kneeling Position.



Figure 64.—Sitting Position.



Figure 65.—Prone Position.

c. General precautions to be taken in handling the rockets are to keep them out of direct sunlight except when immediately ready to load; to handle them carefully and not drop them after the safety pin has been removed; to avoid allowing a rocket to remain in a hot launcher prior to firing, and to avoid attempting to fire the rockets at temperatures below zero degrees F or above 120 degrees F.

Below 14° F, the dry cell batteries which furnish the electric current for firing this weapon become too weak to function. Under these conditions, they must be removed and kept warm until ready to fire.